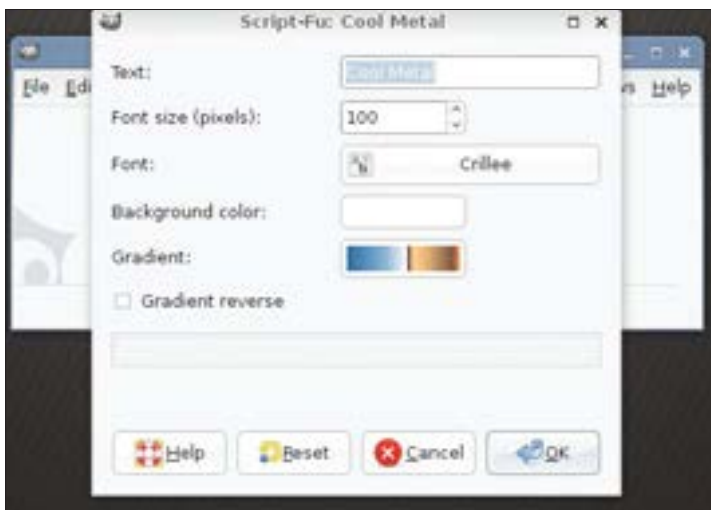


the layers, channels and patterns window are independent applications although they all work together. In this aspect, the Gimp is totally unique from other image manipulation software.

Gimp makes it easy for everyone to jump right in. Go to File > Create to get a jumpstart on common photo editing activities. This includes buttons, logos and web page templates, all with tweakable presets.



In four clicks, a logo complete with layer effects, transparencies and gradients is ready, which would have taken much longer in Photoshop.

The toolbox of Gimp is organised in an intuitive and uncomplicated way. All the tools available are in front of you from the start, with no hidden tools in tool sub-menus. There is a lot possible with each tool and the interface to tweak shows up in the bottom half of the toolbox when you select a particular tool. Look at the wealth of options available for the brush. Such options are available for all the tools.

Hover around any tool to get a concise description of what the tool does. The right side of the screen is divided into two panels. The top panel has layers, channels, paths and the change history in tabs. The bottom half has brushes, patterns and gradients where relevant.